Grade 7 · Module 1 Comprehensive gap assessment - TEACHER ANSWER KEY

Scheduled: 2026-11-06 | Required writing, hands-on/science, social studies, and Spanish gap work. Complete the separately listed Khan assessments for primary-course coverage.

Math: 7.RP.1-2 | ELA: RL.7.1-10; RI.7.1-10; W.7.1-9; L.7.1-6; SL.7.1-6 (grade-level coverage; module skill targets below) | Science: L.7.3 | Social Studies: MS CCRS SS Grade 7 Early World History - prehistory/Mesopotamia | Spanish: MS World Languages Framework 2016 - Novice communication

Award points by item. Accept equivalent correct mathematical forms and supported written interpretations. For open responses, use the stated rubric; do not require identical wording. Score each subject separately, then apply your grading policy.

Writing and conventions · required gap check - 12 points

Score: _____ / 12

A Pond Study

A class studied a small pond near its school. Students recorded water temperature, counted visible organisms from the bank, and drew a model of a food web. Because the first visit happened after rain, they wondered whether that single visit represented typical conditions. They returned at the same time of day during three later weeks. Their records were not identical. One student wanted to erase the unusual measurements, but her partner argued that differences could be useful evidence. The group kept the records and described the limits of its method: it had observed only one pond and had not counted organisms beneath the water. Their report distinguished observations from explanations. "We saw fewer insects" was an observation; "the cooler temperature caused the change" was a hypothesis that needed further testing. The study taught the class that careful questions are as important as confident conclusions.

1. Using the supplied passage, write two organized paragraphs explaining its central message. Include two accurate details and explain how they support your response. (5 points)

Answer / scoring: 5-point rubric: accurate central message (1), two relevant text details (2), logical explanation/organization (1), clear sentences/conventions (1). Accept supported interpretations.

2. Revise two sentences from your response. Explain one change that improves grammar, word choice, or clarity. (3 points)

Answer / scoring: 3-point rubric: two effective revisions (2); accurate explanation of one improvement (1).

3. Connect your writing to this module's Khan reading/grammar goals. Name two skills, show an example of each in your own writing, and explain your choices. (4 points)

Answer / scoring: 4-point rubric: two appropriate module skills identified (2), two accurate applications explained (2). Check against the module's listed learning goals.

Science - 28 points

Score: _____ / 28

W1 data: A fictional survey uses the same area and observation time in two habitats. Trial A: 9 distinct species observed; Trial B: 15 distinct species observed. These are invented assessment data, not a claim about a real investigation.

W2 data: A fictional survey uses the same area and observation time in two habitats. Trial A: 10 distinct species observed; Trial B: 16 distinct species observed. These are invented assessment data, not a claim about a real investigation.

W3 data: A fictional survey uses the same area and observation time in two habitats. Trial A: 11 distinct species observed; Trial B: 17 distinct species observed. These are invented assessment data, not a claim about a real investigation.

W4 data: A fictional survey uses the same area and observation time in two habitats. Trial A: 12 distinct species observed; Trial B: 18 distinct species observed. These are invented assessment data, not a claim about a real investigation.

1. Why is the water cycle a cycle rather than a one-way path? (1 point)

Answer / scoring: Water moves among reservoirs through repeated processes.

2. Use W1 data. Which trial has the higher recorded value, and by how much? (2 points)

Answer / scoring: Trial B; 6 distinct species observed.

3. Model water and carbon movement in an ecosystem. (3 points)

Answer / scoring: Rubric (3): scientifically accurate parts/ideas (1); correct relationships/reasoning (1); clear labels/evidence or method (1). Correct reservoirs, processes, and arrows; distinguish movement of matter from energy flow.

4. How do photosynthesis and respiration relate to oxygen? (1 point)

Answer / scoring: Photosynthesis releases oxygen; many organisms use oxygen in cellular respiration.

5. Use W2 data. Which trial has the higher recorded value, and by how much? (2 points)

Answer / scoring: Trial B; 6 distinct species observed.

6. Model a nitrogen or oxygen cycle. (3 points)

Answer / scoring: Rubric (3): scientifically accurate parts/ideas (1); correct relationships/reasoning (1); clear labels/evidence or method (1). Relevant reservoirs and correct processes; arrows show repeated matter movement.

7. What does cellular respiration do? (1 point)

Answer / scoring: Release usable energy from organic molecules; aerobic respiration uses oxygen.

8. Use W3 data. Which trial has the higher recorded value, and by how much? (2 points)

Answer / scoring: Trial B; 6 distinct species observed.

9. Compare photosynthesis with aerobic cellular respiration. (3 points)

Answer / scoring: Rubric (3): scientifically accurate parts/ideas (1); correct relationships/reasoning (1); clear labels/evidence or method (1). Correct inputs/outputs and energy roles; do not say matter or energy is created from nothing.

10. What is an ecosystem service? (1 point)

Answer / scoring: A benefit people receive from ecosystems, such as pollination or water regulation.

11. Use W4 data. Which trial has the higher recorded value, and by how much? (2 points)

Answer / scoring: Trial B; 6 distinct species observed.

12. Model a food web and a possible effect of losing one species. (3 points)

Answer / scoring: Rubric (3): scientifically accurate parts/ideas (1); correct relationships/reasoning (1); clear labels/evidence or method (1). At least four organisms with correct energy-flow arrows and a plausible cascade/alternative pathway.

13. Choose one of the supplied data comparisons. Write a claim supported by those data, give the two values as evidence, and explain what further information would be needed for a causal explanation. (4 points)

Answer / scoring: Rubric (4): accurate limited claim (1); two correct data values (1); logical connection to claim (1); relevant limitation/next test (1). Accept varied claims bounded by the supplied data.

Social Studies - 24 points

Score: _____ / 24

W1 background: The period before written records for a society; it does not mean people lacked history. Resources, climate, population, opportunities, and other pressures could influence movement. This is an assessment background note written for this packet, not an actual historical primary-source quotation.

W2 background: It supported more permanent settlements and changed work, resources, and social organization. No; crops, environments, timing, and choices varied. This is an assessment background note written for this packet, not an actual historical primary-source quotation.

W3 background: They supported water access, irrigation, transport, and fertile lands while posing flood risks. Specialized work, institutions, networks, writing in some societies, or organized infrastructure. This is an assessment background note written for this packet, not an actual historical primary-source quotation.

W4 background: A writing system using wedge-shaped marks, associated with ancient Mesopotamia. They show rules/ideals and authority, but not necessarily how every case was handled. This is an assessment background note written for this packet, not an actual historical primary-source quotation.

1. What does prehistory mean? (1 point)

Answer / scoring: The period before written records for a society; it does not mean people lacked history.

2. Why might early humans migrate? (1 point)

Answer / scoring: Resources, climate, population, opportunities, and other pressures could influence movement.

3. Model an early migration question. (3 points)

Answer / scoring: Rubric (3): accurate relevant content (1); supported comparison/relationship (1); clear organization and source/evidence awareness (1). Route, possible motivations, archaeological evidence, and uncertainty; avoid one cause for all migrations.

4. How did agriculture change some human communities? (1 point)

Answer / scoring: It supported more permanent settlements and changed work, resources, and social organization.

5. Was adopting agriculture an identical process everywhere? (1 point)

Answer / scoring: No; crops, environments, timing, and choices varied.

6. Compare foraging and early farming. (3 points)

Answer / scoring: Rubric (3): accurate relevant content (1); supported comparison/relationship (1); clear organization and source/evidence awareness (1). Food production, movement/settlement, benefits, costs, and recognition of variation.

7. Why were the Tigris and Euphrates important in Mesopotamia? (1 point)

Answer / scoring: They supported water access, irrigation, transport, and fertile lands while posing flood risks.

8. What is one feature of an early city/civilization? (1 point)

Answer / scoring: Specialized work, institutions, networks, writing in some societies, or organized infrastructure.

9. Model river, agriculture, and city development. (3 points)

Answer / scoring: Rubric (3): accurate relevant content (1); supported comparison/relationship (1); clear organization and source/evidence awareness (1). Correct connections plus one benefit and one challenge; avoid saying rivers automatically create states.

10. What is cuneiform? (1 point)

Answer / scoring: A writing system using wedge-shaped marks, associated with ancient Mesopotamia.

11. Why are written laws useful historical evidence? (1 point)

Answer / scoring: They show rules/ideals and authority, but not necessarily how every case was handled.

12. Compare a law text with evidence of everyday life. (3 points)

Answer / scoring: Rubric (3): accurate relevant content (1); supported comparison/relationship (1); clear organization and source/evidence awareness (1). Different evidence types, each source's limits, and one question for corroboration.

13. Choose one background note. Describe an additional perspective or source that could improve it, and explain what it might reveal or challenge. (4 points)

Answer / scoring: Rubric (4): identifies chosen note/claim (1); relevant additional source/perspective (1); explains new insight/check (1); recognizes limits rather than treating one source as complete truth (1).